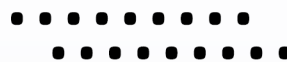




2023



REGIONAL ECONOMIC SITUATIONER NATIONAL CAPITAL REGION





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Sources of Data

Philippine Statistics Authority - National Capital Region

Regional Accounts of the Philippines

Retail Price Survey of Commodities for the Generation of Consumer Price Index

Labor Force Survey

Approved Investment of the Philippines

Poverty and Food Subsistence Incidence

Department of Tourism - National Capital Region

Data on Visitors Arrival (same-day visitors and overnight visitors)

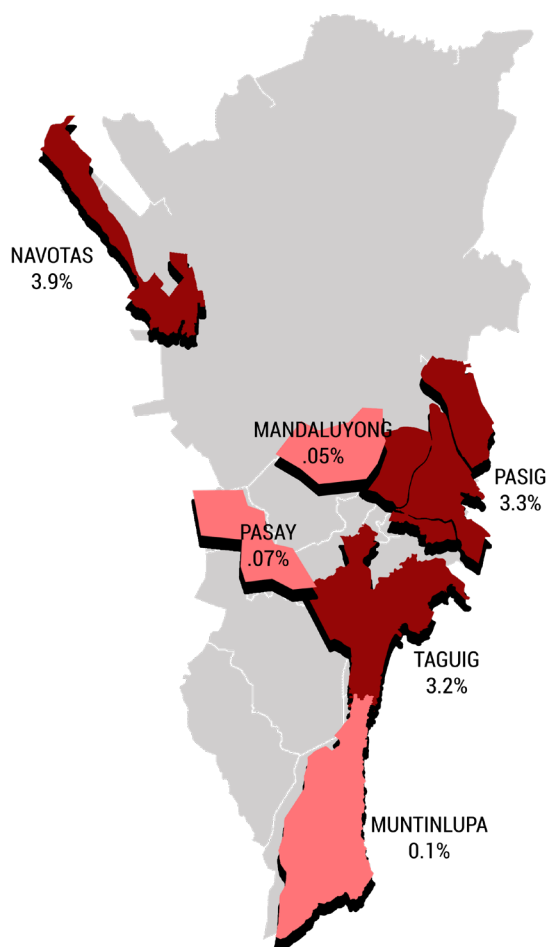


Demographic Profile



Demographic Profile of the National Capital Region

Poverty Incidence



The poverty incidence among population in the National Capital Region (NCR) improved with the reported decrease from 3.5 percent or 482,480 individuals in 2021 to 1.8 percent or 262,240 people living under the regional annual per capita poverty threshold of PHP 37,711 in 2023. It is the lowest percentage recorded among all the regions in the Philippines in 2023 and lower than the 2.2 percent regional poverty incidence posted before the pandemic in 2018.

At the local level, the City of Navotas recorded the highest poverty incidence rate among population in 2023 at 3.9 percent with 9,670 individuals, followed by the City of Pasig (3.3%), and the City of Taguig (3.2%). Meanwhile, the City of Muntinlupa generated the lowest incidence rate at 0.1 percent, followed by the City of Mandaluyong (0.5%), and Pasay City (0.7%).



Table 1. Poverty Incidence Among Population and Estimated Magnitude of Poor Population in NCR, 2021 and 2023

CITY/ MUNICIPALITY	POVERTY INCIDENCE		ESTIMATED MAGNITUDE OF POOR POPULATION ('000)	
	2021	2023	2021	2023
National Capital Region (NCR)	3.5	1.8	482.48	262.24
City of Caloocan	6.0	3.0	100.71	51.34
City of Las Piñas	3.9	1.3	24.17	8.10
City of Makati	1.5	1.0	9.50	6.75
City of Malabon	4.6	2.3	17.22	8.81

CITY/ MUNICIPALITY	POVERTY INCIDENCE		ESTIMATED MAGNITUDE OF POOR POPULATION ('000)	
	2021	2023	2021	2023
City of Mandaluyong	0.7	0.5	3.13	2.42
City of Manila	1.7	2.4	32.12	46.54
City of Marikina	2.6	0.9	12.24	4.39
City of Muntinlupa	2.5	0.1	14.05	0.71
City of Navotas	5.1	3.9	12.67	9.67
City of Parañaque	4.3	0.9	32.76	7.38
City of Pasig	3.5	3.3	30.19	29.17
City of San Juan	-	-	-	-
City of Taguig	6.5	3.2	65.34	34.61
City of Valenzuela	2.1	1.3	14.07	8.52
Pasay City	4.0	0.7	17.26	3.07
Pateros	4.5	1.4	2.93	0.92
Quezon City	3.0	1.3	94.13	39.85

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority

The NCR continues to improve the lives of poor households through the implementation of the *Pantawid Pamilyang Pilipino Program* (4Ps). In 2023, the second round of its special assessment was conducted to ensure that validated and in-need households will be included in the *Listahanan 3* or the National Household Targeting System for Poverty Reduction (NHTS-PR). Further, various livelihood and cash for work programs were implemented to manage economic risks among vulnerable households such as DOLE Integrated Livelihood Program (DILP), *Tulong Panghanap-buhay sa Ating Disadvantaged/Displaced Workers* (TUPAD) Program, and Sustainable Livelihood Program (SLP).

Subsistence Incidence

In 2023, the NCR recorded the lowest subsistence incidence among its population with 0.1 percent or 63,560 individuals living below the annual per capita food threshold of PHP 26,334. It is lower than the 0.5 percent or 14,760 subsistence incidence among population posted in 2021, highlighting the improvement of the social sector where more individuals have enough income to meet their basic food needs.



Table 2. Subsistence Incidence and Estimated Magnitude of Subsistence Poor Population in NCR,2021 and 2023

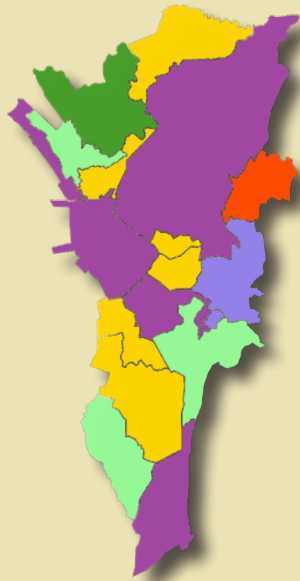
CITY/ MUNICIPALITY	SUBSISTENCE INCIDENCE		ESTIMATED MAGNITUDE OF SUBSISTENCE POOR POPULATION ('000)	
	2021	2023	2021	2023
National Capital Region (NCR)	0.5	0.1	63.56	14.76
City of Caloocan	0.5	0.1	8.82	1.28
City of Las Piñas	0.7	-	4.12	-
City of Makati	0.4	0.5	2.54	3.07
City of Malabon	0.3	-	1.12	-
City of Mandaluyong	0.1	0.0	0.35	0.17
City of Manila	-	0.2	-	3.03
City of Marikina	-	0.2	-	0.96
City of Muntinlupa	0.3	-	1.85	-
City of Navotas	0.9	-	2.13	-
City of Parañaque	0.8	-	5.67	-
City of Pasig	0.2	0.1	1.86	0.90
City of San Juan	-	-	-	-
City of Taguig	0.5	0.5	5.47	5.36
City of Valenzuela	-	-	-	-
Pasay City	1.2	-	5.42	-
Pateros	0.5	-	0.30	-
Quezon City	0.8	-	23.90	-

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority

Economic Profile

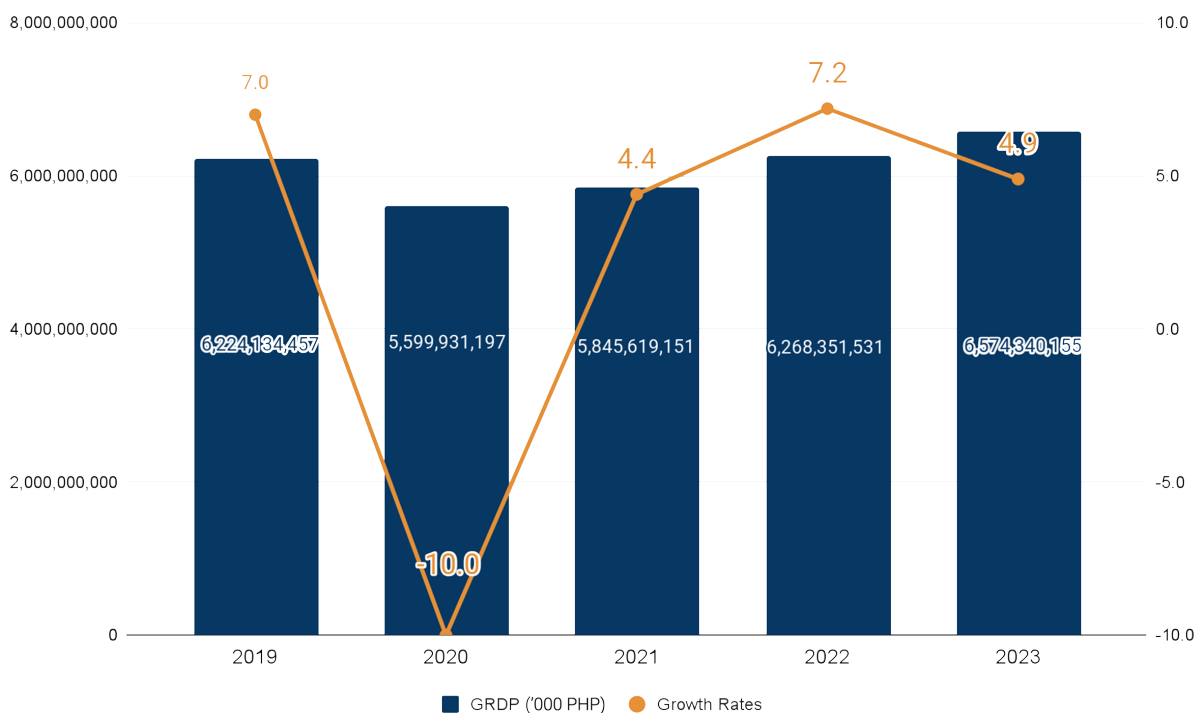


Gross Regional Domestic Product (GRDP)



Among the other regions in the country, the National Capital Region (NCR) recorded the highest economic output in 2023 with PHP 6.57 trillion GRDP, representing 31.2 percent of the national Gross Domestic Product (GDP). However, despite various economic activities in the region, the NCR recorded a lower growth rate than the previous year with 4.9 percent from 7.2 percent in 2022, ranking the NCR 11th in terms of growth.

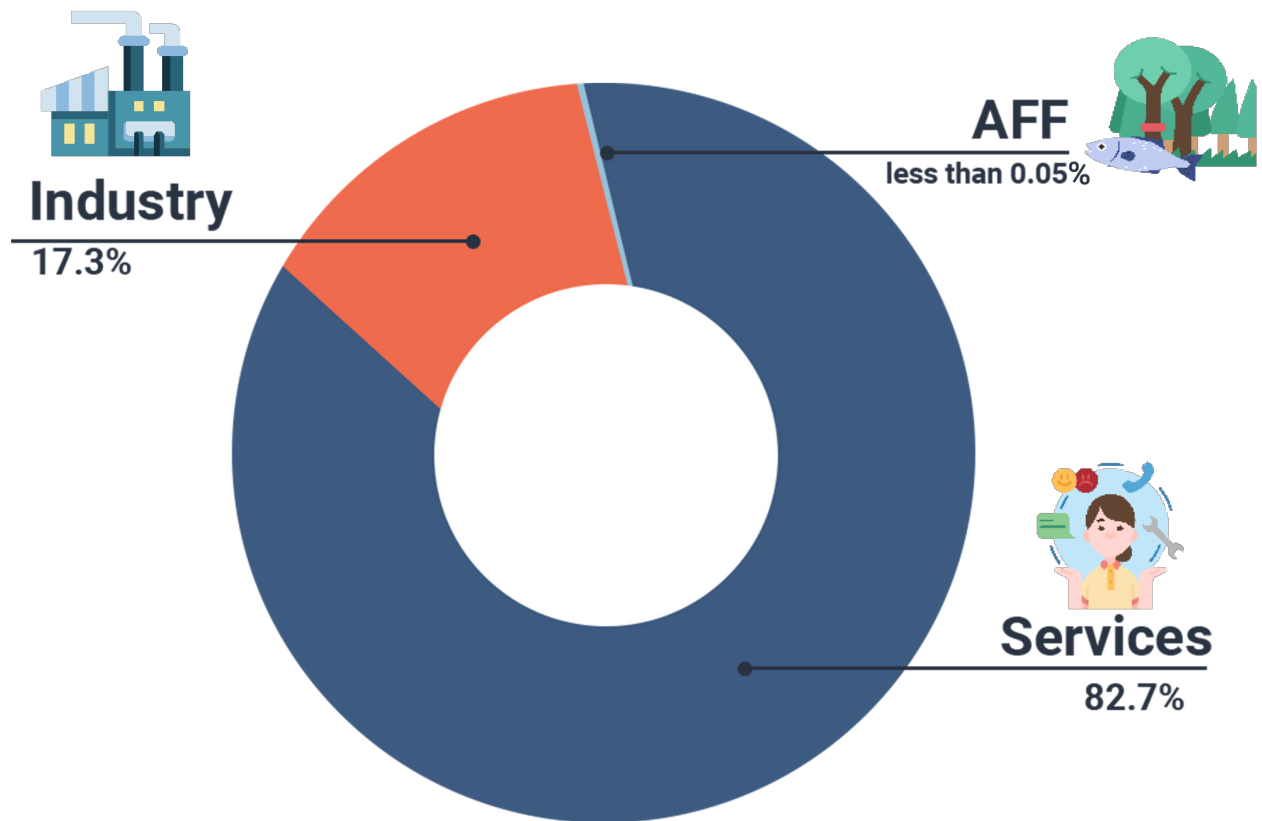
The easing of economic growth compared to the previous year was expected as the activities of industries returned to normal from the pandemic, but it can be noted that the price hikes in some commodities also affected the output of large industries and contributed to the slower performance of the region.



Source: Philippine Statistics Authority

Figure 1. Gross Regional Domestic Product Levels and Growth Rates, NCR, 2019-2023 (At Constant 2018 Prices)

The NCR's GRDP is mainly attributed to the exemplary performance of the Services and Industry Sectors with 82.7 percent and 17.3 percent share of the region's economy, respectively. These sectors serve as its main drivers and greatly contribute to the overall economic growth of the country, making Metro Manila one of the top-performing regions in 2023.



Source: Philippine Statistics Authority

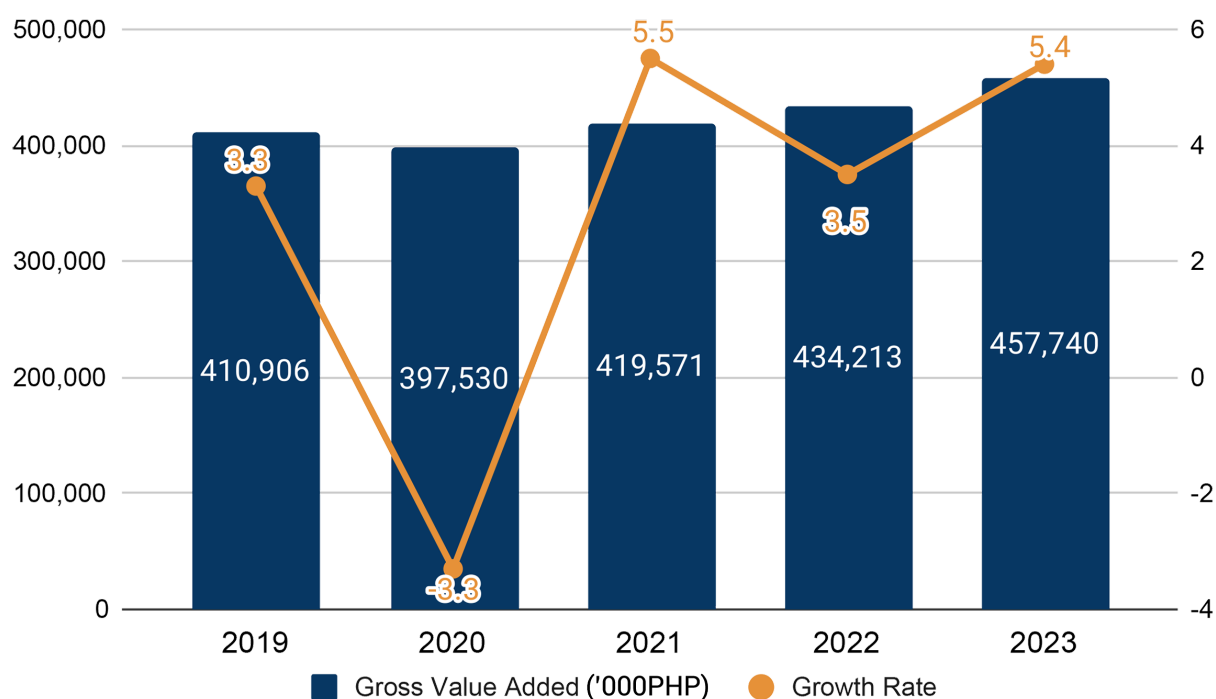
**Figure 2. Percent Share of Sectors to GRDP of NCR, 2023
(At Constant 2018 Prices)**

As the country's center of economic activities, the NCR is committed to pursuing growth by transforming sectors to generate more quality jobs and competitive products through modernizing agriculture and agri-business, revitalizing the industry sector, reinvigorating services, advancing research and development, technology, and innovation, as well as promoting trade and investments.

Agriculture, Forestry, and Fishing (AFF) Sector

The AFF sector had the lowest contribution to the region's economic output in 2023 with less than 0.05 percent share or PHP 457.7 million Gross Value Added (GVA), mainly contributed by the performance of ancillary services of the AFF-related establishments and fisheries. Despite this, the AFF was the only sector to generate a positive growth rate from 3.5 percent in 2022 to 5.4 percent compared to the other sectors.





Source: Philippine Statistics Authority

**Figure 3. Gross Value Added and Growth Rate of the AFF Sector in NCR, 2023
(At Constant 2018 Prices)**

The fisheries industry has a crucial contribution to the AFF sector of NCR with seven (7) local government units (LGUs), namely Cities of Navotas, Manila, Parañaque, Las Piñas, Muntinlupa, Taguig, and Pasay City that are actively engaging in agriculture-related activities such as capture fishing, aquaculture, and inland and municipal fishing. Some of the common fish commodities harvested in the NCR are tilapia, bangus, and shrimp.

In 2023, an increase in the volume of production for these commodities was observed, achieving their respective regional targets. This is attributed to the efforts of the concerned LGUs and other stakeholders in repopulating the fishing areas in the region and providing inputs to individual fisherfolk and commercial businesses.

Table 3. Target and Volume of Production of Selected Fisheries Commodities in NCR ('000 MT), 2023

COMMODITIES	2023 TARGET	2023 ACCOMPLISHMENT
Tilapia	1.52	1.58
Bangus	0.30	0.72
Shrimp	5.04	5.45

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority, Department of Agriculture

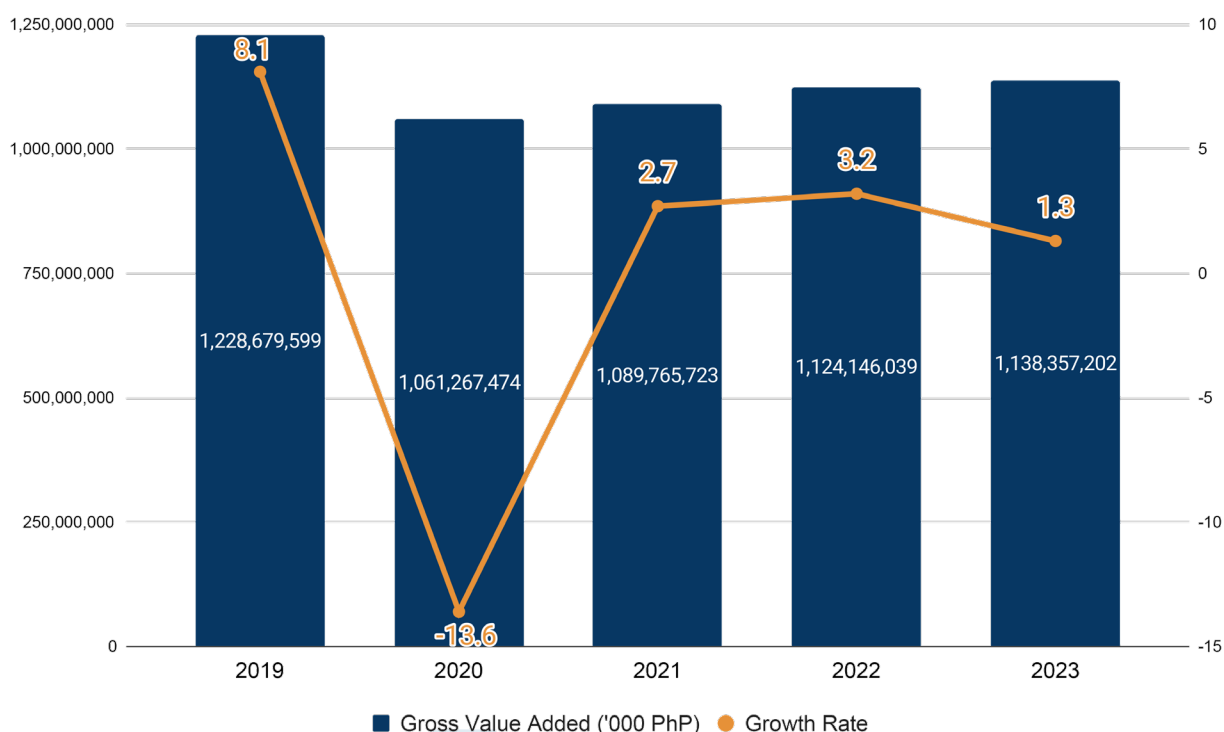
Various programs were implemented in the region to further improve the lives of the stakeholders and the fishing industry, such as Fisheries Development, Fisheries Regulatory and Law Enforcement, and Fisheries Extension Programs.



Industry Sector

In 2023, the NCR recorded the second largest contribution to the national industry sector with PHP 1.13 trillion or 18.6 percent share to its overall GVA. At the regional level, it represents 17.6 percent of the economic performance of Metro Manila, making it the second main driver of its economy. The industries that supported the sector in the region are manufacturing with 11.9 percent share, followed by construction (3.9%), electricity, steam, water and waste management (1.4%), and mining and quarrying (0.01%).

Supporting this growth were government programs such as the Shared Service Facilities (SSF) and Center for Innovation and Technology for Enterprises (CITE) which aim to provide technical and technological assistance to micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs), especially in the field of manufacturing industry. Moreover, the ongoing implementation of the LRT Lines 1 and 2 Extension Projects and Public-Private Partnership Concessionaires in upgrading the airport terminals in the region played a significant role in the sector's overall performance in 2023.



Source: Philippine Statistics Authority

**Figure 4. Gross Value Added and Growth Rate of the Industry Sector in NCR, 2023
(At Constant 2018 Prices)**

However, a decrease in the sector's growth was observed from 2022-2023, recording 1.3 percent from 3.2 percent in 2021-2022. Among the industries under it, manufacturing generated the slowest growth with 0.4 percent, followed by mining and quarrying (2.3%) and construction (2.5%).



Table 4. Share of Industry Sector by Industry in NCR (at Constant 2018 Prices), 2023

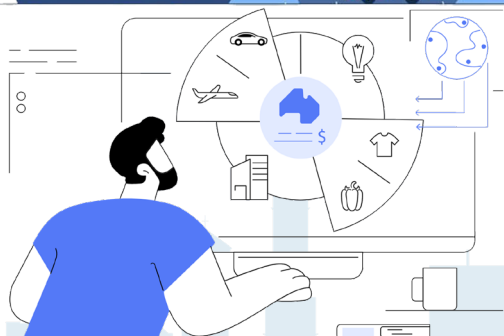
INDUSTRY	GROSS VALUE ADDED ('000)	PERCENT SHARE TO THE GRDP (%)	GROWTH RATE (%)
Industry Sector	1,138,357,202	17.3	1.3
Mining and Quarrying	456,559	0.01	2.3
Manufacturing	785,259,760	11.9	0.4
Electricity, steam, water and waste management	93,675,994	1.4	5.2
Construction	258,964,889	3.9	2.5

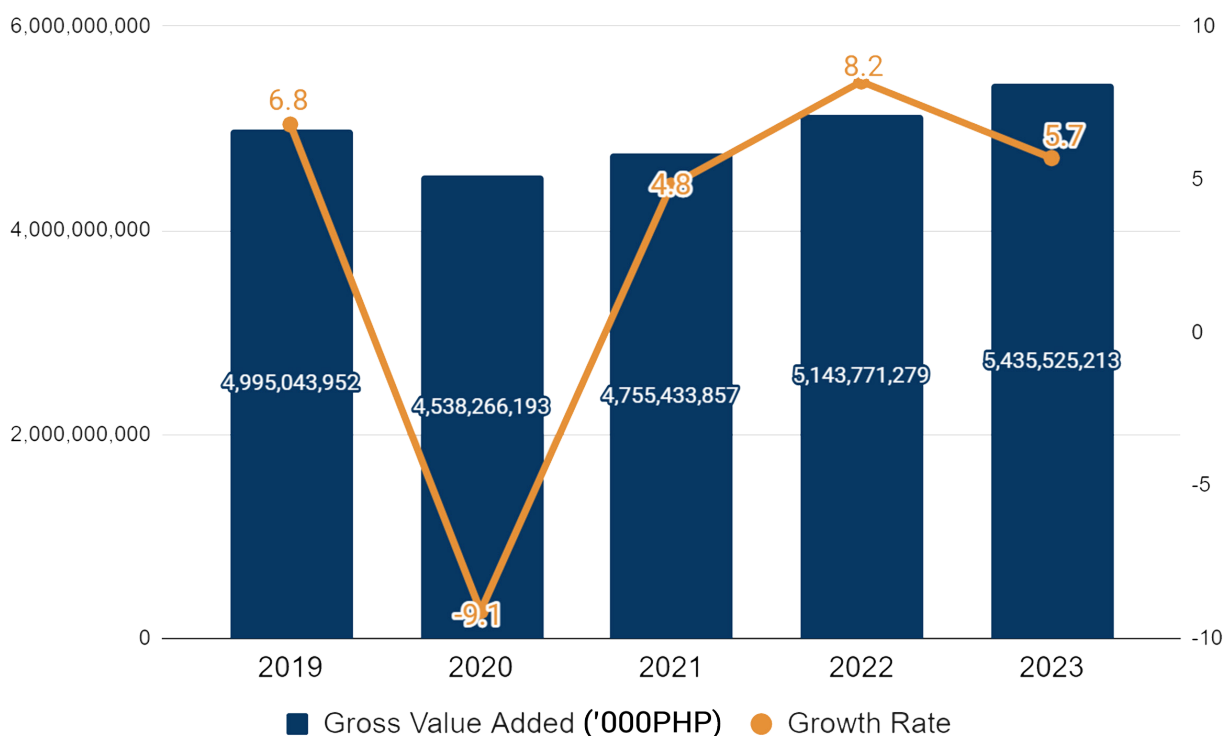
Source: Philippine Statistics Authority

Service Sector



The Service Sector remained the top contributor to the NCR's economy with 82.7 percent or PHP 5.43 trillion shares to its GRDP. It comprised the largest contribution of 41.4 percent to the national GVA of the sector in the country in 2023. Further, among the 16 sub-industries of the sector, the wholesale and retail trade, and repair of motor vehicles and motorcycles recorded the highest share with 22.9 percent, followed by financial and insurance activities (19.8%), professional and business services (13.0%), and public administration and defense; compulsory social activities (8.6%).





Source: Philippine Statistics Authority

**Figure 5. Gross Value Added and Growth Rate of the Services Sector in NCR, 2023
(At Constant 2018 Prices)**

In terms of the sector's growth, a decrease was recorded from 8.2 percent in 2021-2022 to 5.7 percent in 2022-2023. The same was observed with some of its top-performing sub-industries. Despite these, remarkable growths were recorded in other services industries (arts, entertainment, and recreation) with 20.6 percent, followed by accommodation and food service activities (19.4%), human health and social work activities (9.5%), and transportation and storage (8.8%), which contributed to the overall growth of the sector.

The growth in the region's accommodation and food services industry was attributed to the increase in the number of visitor arrivals in Metro Manila and various programs implemented to promote the region's tourism products and services. In addition, the increase in the overall number of passengers transported via sea, rails, and air in 2023 played a crucial part in the performance of the transportation and storage industry.

Table 5. Share of Services Sector by Industry in NCR (at Constant 2018 Prices), 2023

INDUSTRY	GROSS VALUE ADDED ('000)	PERCENT SHARE TO THE GRDP (%)	GROWTH RATE (%)
Services	5,435,525,213	82.7	5.7
Wholesale and retail trade; repair of motor vehicles and motorcycles	1,502,243,371	22.9	4.4
Transportation and Storage	163,566,092	2.5	8.8
Accommodation and food service activities	77,028,579	1.2	19.4
Information and Communication	168,462,212	2.6	3.2
Financial and insurance activities	1,303,177,165	19.8	8.0

INDUSTRY	GROSS VALUE ADDED ('000)	PERCENT SHARE TO THE GRDP (%)	GROWTH RATE (%)
Real estate and ownership of dwellings	398,997,468	6.1	3.7
Professional and business services	851,682,487	13.0	5.8
Public administration and defense; compulsory social activities	562,698,772	8.6	-1.1
Education	130,327,705	2.0	7.1
Human health and social work activities	126,107,065	1.9	9.5
Other services	151,234,296	2.3	20.6

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority

Inflation

A decreasing trend was observed in the inflation rate of all items in NCR in 2023, from 8.6 percent in January to 3.5 in December. On average, the NCR recorded a 6.2 percent inflation rate for the whole year of 2023 which mostly contributed by the average inflation rate which mostly contributed by the following average inflation rate in:



Restaurants and accommodation services (8.7%)



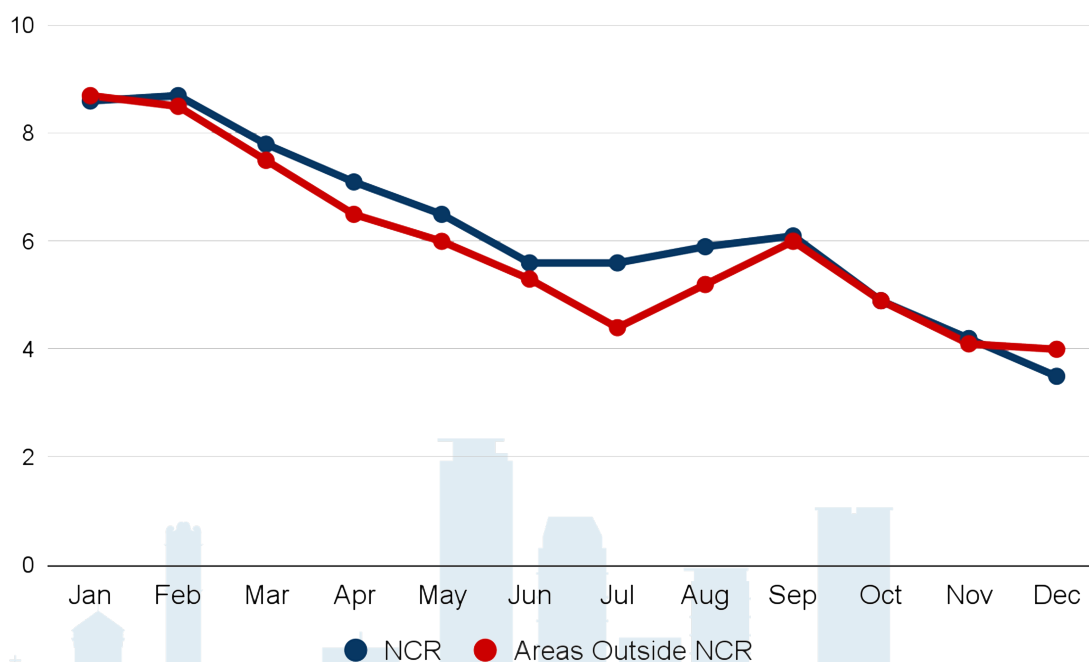
Food and non-alcoholic beverages (7.4%)



Alcoholic beverages and tobacco (6.7%)



Housing, water, electricity, gas and other fuels (6.7%)



Source: Philippine Statistics Authority

Figure 6. Monthly Inflation Rate for All Items in NCR and Areas Outside NCR, 2023

The inflation rate of restaurants and accommodation services was driven by the increase in food prices, which posed a big challenge to the industry during the first month of 2023, recording 10.4 percent in January. It further increased in April to 11.4 percent, but slowly declined in the third and fourth quarters with a 5.3 percent rate in December as the prices of primary food commodities slowed down. Meanwhile, the food commodities and non-alcoholic beverages started at 12.1 percent inflation rate in January and decreased to 2.8 percent in December as the cost for basic commodities such as agricultural products (vegetables and meat) eased. The improvement in the supply side of these agricultural commodities also contributed to the attainment of a lower inflation rate at the end of the year.

The 6.7 average inflation rate in housing, water, electricity, gas, and other fuels was attributed to the changes in house rentals, electricity rates, and water tariffs in 2023, generating 6.9 percent in January and slowing down at 4.8 percent in December. Alcoholic beverages and tobacco, on the other hand, recorded an inflation rate of 6.6 percent in January to 6.2 percent in December.

Table 6. Average Inflation Rate by Commodity Group in NCR, 2022 and 2023

COMMODITIES	2022	2023
ALL ITEMS	5.1	6.2
Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages	5.4	7.4
Alcoholic Beverages and Tobacco	6.4	6.7
Clothing and Footwear	1.7	2.6
Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels	4.6	6.7
Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household Maintenance	3.1	5.9
Health	1.4	2.4
Transport	13.3	2.6
Information and Communication	0.3	0.4
Recreation, Sport and Culture	1.5	3.1
Education Services	3.3	6.0
Restaurants and Accommodation Services	5.1	8.7
Financial Services	8.6	0.0
Personal Care, and Miscellaneous Goods and Services	2.1	3.7

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority

Employment



In 2023, an increase in the labor force participation rate in NCR was observed, posting 61.8 percent or 6,420,261 of the fifteen-year-old and over population in the region. It was higher than the 60.5 percent or 6,202,938 from the previous year.

As the region's economy continued to flourish, employment in Metro Manila generated an increase in employment rate with 94.6 percent or 6,072,925 workers in 2023 from 94.4 percent or 5,857,248 or 94.4 percent in 2022. Likewise, a decrease in the unemployment rate was recorded with 5.4 percent or 347,336 individuals from 5.6 percent in the previous year. Various government programs contributed to these improvements such as the institutionalization of the Public Employment Service Office (PESO) and the implementation of PhilJobNet which aim to connect the job seekers to the labor market, as well

as the promotion of investments in the region that generated additional employment.

However, despite these, an increase was recorded in the underemployment rate of NCR, generating 7.7 percent or 469,437 employees in 2023 from 7.4 percent or 431,328 in 2022. To address the gaps in the abilities and mismatch of skills, government programs such as the Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET), Special Program for Employment of Students (SPES), Government Internship Program (GIP), and Career Development Support Program (CDSP) were implemented to assist individuals in finding suitable job opportunities.

Table 7. Labor Force Participation, Employment, Unemployment, and Underemployment Rates in NCR, 2022 and 2023

LABOR FORCE INDICATORS IN NCR	2022	2023
Labor Force Participation		
Labor Force Participation Rate (%)	60.5	61.8
Total Number of Labor Force Participation	6,202,938	6,420,261
Employment		
Employment Rate (%)	94.4	94.6
Total Number of Employed	5,857,248	6,072,925
Unemployment		
Unemployment Rate (%)	5.6	5.4
Total Number of Unemployed	345,690	347,336
Underemployment		
Underemployment Rate (%)	7.4	7.7
Total Number of Underemployed	431,328	469,437

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority
 Note: Details may not sum up due to rounding.
 2022 - Final results
 2023 - Preliminary

Investments



Three years after the pandemic, positive changes were observed in the Foreign and Filipino national investments in the NCR. In 2023, a total of PHP 46.7 billion approved investment was recorded for the region with more than a hundred percent increase from the PHP 16.4 billion investment in 2022. It comprised investments from foreign and Filipino nationals, making Metro Manila the 9th region with the most received investments among other areas of the country.

NCR's investments from Filipino nationals had the most notable growth with PHP 38.2 billion or 238.4 percent increase from the PHP 11.3 billion investment in 2022. This placed Metro Manila in the top five (5) recipient regions for local investments. Meanwhile, a 66.2 percent increase was recorded from foreign investments in NCR, generating PHP 8.4 billion from PHP 5.0 billion investments in 2022 and ranking 10th among the destination regions of the said investment.

Table 8. Approved Foreign and Filipino Nationals Investments in the NCR, 2022 and 2023

COMMODITIES	2022	2023	PERCENT CHANGE (%)
Foreign Investments (in million pesos)	5,064.66	8,419.5	66.2
Filipino National Investments (in million pesos)	11,300.68	38,239.7	238.4
Total Investments (in million pesos)	16,365.34	46,659.2	185.1

*Source: Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA)
Note: Details may not sum up due to rounding*

Tourism

The NCR serves as the primary entry point to all the tourist destinations in the Philippines, attracting large numbers of foreign and domestic tourists. In 2023, the NCR recorded 32,482,842 same-day visitors with a 35.2 percent growth rate from the previous year. It comprised 874,460 foreign visitors which is a significant increase from 2022 and 31,608,382 domestic visitors with 32.0 percent growth.

Meanwhile, the number of overnight visitors generated a positive growth of 26.4 percent and posted 7,143,531 total visitors in the same year. This was attributed to the 2,368,418 foreign visitors, 4,757,085 domestic visitors, and 18,028 overseas visitors in the region. All the types of visitors generated a positive growth rate except overseas visitors with 74.7 percent, 12.9 percent, and -78.9 percent, respectively.

Different government programs and projects contributed to the growth and improvements in the NCR's tourism industry, such as the implementation of the Hop-On Hop-Off (HOHO) project, the launching of food festivals, assistance to film industries, support in hosting international sports and esports competitions, support of cruise tourism, and participation in various medical/dental events. Moreover, partnerships with the ride-sharing service providers for possible exclusive tours in the region, and the development of Tourism and Cultural Development Plans (TCDP) at the local level were some of the ways forward to further develop the tourism industry.



Table 9. Visitor Arrivals in NCR, 2022-2023

VISITORS	2022	2023	GROWTH RATE
Same day Visitors	24,033,149	32,482,842	35.2%
Foreign visitors	94,677	874,460	823.6%
Domestic visitors	23,938,472	31,608,382	32.0%
Overseas visitors	-	-	-
Overnight Visitors	5,653,069	7,143,531	26.4%
Foreign visitors	1,356,036	2,368,418	74.7%
Domestic visitors	4,212,906	4,757,085	12.9%
Overseas visitors	84,127	18,028	-78.6%

As of July 2024

Source: Department of Tourism - National Capital Region

Note: Data submissions mainly came from selected cities of the region.

The NCR's tourism industry also highlights a large number of accredited tourism establishments, such as hotels, hotel apartments, resorts, and mabuhay accommodations, among others. However, in 2023, accredited establishments in the region declined to 1,278 from the 1,332 establishments in 2022. This was attributed to the implementation of stricter accreditation criteria in the region which pose a challenge to the owners.

Challenges, Prospects, and Strategies



Challenges, Prospects, and Strategies

Ensuring food sufficiency, accessibility, and availability in the region through the promotion and development of urban agriculture. In the early months of 2023, prices of primary commodities such as agricultural products spiked and greatly affected the inflation rate in Metro Manila as challenges in the supply side emerged.

Hence, the National Urban and Peri-Urban Agriculture Program (NUPAP) will be continuously promoted and implemented in Metro Manila through (a) establishment of greenhouses with hydroponics systems and nurseries, (b) distribution of planting materials and modules for rabbit production and chicken production, (c) provision of a package of technology and training activities to expand urban agriculture, and (d) support the establishment of school gardens in the region. Moreover, a technology demonstration at the local level will be provided to develop and further improve the livelihood of the region's key players in the agriculture sector.



Improving the employability of the workers in the region by addressing skill and ability gaps.

Job-skills mismatch is one of the pressing challenges in the employment and labor market.



As the business sector shifts to more advanced operations and participates in a more competitive market, various skills and knowledge are required and demanded from the labor market. This further widens the gap between the current capabilities of workers and the demanded skills. To enhance the competitiveness and competencies of youth employment in the labor market, the Special Program for Employment of Students (SPES) will be expanded and the involvement of the private sector in the program will be strengthened through advocacy orientations and coordination with the established Tripartite Industrial Peace Council (TIPC) in the region. Further, the Job Placement Office (JPO) in Higher Educational Institutions (HEIs) and Senior High Schools will be established to link the graduates with potential employers directly. Through the DOLE Adjustment Measures Program (DOLE-AMP) for Workers and Enterprises, financial assistance will also be provided to enterprises that aim to upgrade their workers' competencies and enhance their transformative capacity.

Enhancing tourism in the local government units for greater economic gains. Overnight visitors recorded a lower number of individuals compared to the same-day visitors that visited the region. Hence, the development of new tourism products and promotion of tourism activities and facilities in each city in the region shall be undertaken to encourage foreign and domestic tourists to spend several days in Metro Manila. This will result in an increase in tourism expenditure, creation of more job opportunities, and improvement of the MSME's livelihoods that support the tourism industry.

One of the regional government's efforts to further nurture the tourism industry includes the diversification of the NCR's product portfolio by highlighting experiences from culture and heritage, arts, food, cruises, film, and conventions, among others. Likewise, the improvement of local tourism governance through the development of the Local Tourism Development Plan and creation of Regional Tourism Satellite Accounts will pave the way for more sustainable and efficient tourism programs that will contribute to the region's economic growth.



Addressing challenges on the transport system and improving movement of the people in the region. Traffic congestion has been one of the pressing issues that the NCR is facing due to the high volume of vehicles and employees traveling in and out of the region. Hence, various projects on the rehabilitation and upgrading of the transport system have been implemented to ensure safety, reliability, and seamless connectivity and further promote active and mass transportation.



There is ongoing construction of the Metro Rail Transit Line 7 (MRT-7) which consists of 14 stations from North EDSA to San Jose del Monte, Bulacan, catering thousands of passengers per day. Moreover, the rehabilitation of the Philippine National Railways-North-South Commuter Railway, construction of some subway stations, and acquisition of brand new trains are some of the priority projects in the region. These will help in alleviating traffic congestion in Metro Manila and meeting the increasing demand on passenger ridership. Likewise, road-widening projects, construction of bicycle lanes and sidewalks, and establishment of bridges are also part of this initiative.

Acknowledgment

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Dir. Shiela Gail S. Quingco

Director III

PLANS AND PROGRAMS FORMULATION DIVISION

Mary Helene V. Alzona

Division Chief/Planning Officer V

Jay-Ann S. Santocildes

Planning Officer III

Jerwin G. Flores

Computer Operator II

John Alvin Santiago

Computer Operator II

PLANS AND PROGRAMS EVALUATION DIVISION

Ellaisa I. Badoy

Planning Officer III